

DENNIS EDUARDO MELARA ZEPEDA

La Libertad, El Salvador | +503 7726-9934 | melaraeduardo661@gmail.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Bilingual Immigration Paralegal with a Bachelor's in Systems Engineering and 3+ years of professional experience. Expert in leveraging technical logic to optimize legal workflows in high-volume US Immigration Law firms. Proven track record of managing complex dockets (EOIR/USCIS) and drafting over 1,500 motions with precision. Detail-oriented professional dedicated to efficiency and zero procedural errors in remote legal environments.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Immigration Law:** EOIR Court Procedures (Venue, Terminate, Substitute), USCIS Forms (I-589, I-918, I-765, I-192), Biometrics & Identity Packages.
- Legal Operations:** Legal Research, Affidavit Drafting, Defective NTA Analysis, Docket Management, Judicial Deadline Compliance.
- Software Proficiency:** Microsoft Office 365 (Advanced Excel/Word), Box (Cloud Management), Adobe Acrobat Pro (Legal Editing), Microsoft Teams, CRM Systems.
- Languages:** Spanish (Native) | English (Professional Working Proficiency).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CONFIDENTIAL US LAW FIRM
Immigration Paralegal (Post-Court & Case Management Specialist)

San Jose, CA (Remote)
2024 – 2025.

- Post-Court Strategy:** Led the post-court department, managing critical 30-day appeal deadlines for **Removal Orders** and processing **Asylum Grants (A05)**.
- Docket Control:** Audited EOIR status daily to coordinate **Change of Venue (COV)** for released detainees and ensure jurisdictional accuracy.
- Advisory & Liaison:** Primary contact for complex case outcomes, educating clients on **I-94** retrieval, PD/Dismissal implications, and voluntary departure compliance.
- Operations:** Developed training guides for case tracking and managed interdepartmental escalations between attorneys and finance.

CONFIDENTIAL US LAW FIRM
Immigration Paralegal (Court & Motions Team)

Dallas, TX (Remote)
2023 – 2024.

- Motion Litigation:** Drafted and filed 1,500+ **Motions to Substitute (MTS)** and **E-28s**. Prepared complex **Motions to Terminate, Vacate, Sever, and Consolidate**.
- Pleadings & Filings:** Executed **Written Pleadings, Form-of-Errata**, and **Mendez-Rojas** filings. Managed monthly Video/Telephonic hearing dockets 30 days in advance.
- Evidence Management:** Audited case files for **Biostamps**, identity documents, and certified translations (Birth/Marriage/Passport) to prevent processing delays.
- Court Compliance:** Facilitated **E-33** and **EOIR-61** filings, ensuring continuous legal representation and procedural accuracy for all active court cases.

CONFIDENTIAL US LAW FIRM
Legal Assistant (Applications & Declarations)

Dallas, TX (Remote)
2022 – 2023

- Application Lifecycle:** Mastered initial filing processes for **I-589 (Asylum)**, **I-765 (EAD)**, and **U-Visas (I-918/I-192)** from inception to submission.
- Narrative Drafting:** Interviewed clients to draft legally structured **Declarations** and **PSG** arguments, translating personal trauma into corroborating legal evidence.
- Package Assembly:** Managed end-to-end evidence collection and **Third-Party Declarations**, ensuring compliance with USCIS and EOIR evidentiary standards.

EDUCATION

- University of El Salvador** | San Salvador | **Computer Systems Engineering (In progress)** (GPA: 8.5/10)